

Nanda dynasty of Magadha was founded after the end of Shishunaga dynasty. There were 9 kings in Nanda dynasty- (1) Ugrasen, called Mahapadma in Puranas (2) Panduk (3) Pandugati (4) Bhootpal (5) Rastrapal (6) Govishanak (7) Dashasiddhak (8) Kaivart (9) Dhanananda. During last years of Nanda dynasty, people became turbulent because of extortion and imposing heavy taxes on small items. By taking advantage of this, Chandragupta Maurya with the help of Chanakya killed Dhanananda and established Maurya Empire. Thus, option (a) is the correct answer.

**19. Who was the last King of Karnata dynasty?**

- (a) Harisimha
- (b) Ramsimha
- (c) Matisimha
- (d) Shyamsimha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**60<sup>th</sup> to 62<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2016**

**Ans. (a)**

The last ruler of Karnata Dynasty was Harisimha Dev. He was a great patron of art and literature. He was the pro-founder of Panji system.

## Greek Invasion

**1. Which one of the following rulers of Magadha was the contemporary of Alexander, the Great?**

- (a) Mahapadmananda
- (b) Dhanananda
- (c) Sukalpa
- (d) Chandragupta Maurya

**44<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000**

**Ans. (b)**

There were eight inheritors of Mahapadmananda found in purans and Buddhist texts. Dhanananda was the ruler contemporary of Alexander, the Great Greek writers referred him to as Agrammes.

**2. Who wrote the Periplus of the Erythraen Sea?**

- (a) Tessius
- (b) Pliny
- (c) Ptolemy
- (d) Strabo

**39<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994**

**Ans. (\*)**

The 'Periplus of the Erythraean Sea' is a Greco-Roman periplus (manuscript document). It describes the opportunities for navigation and trade from the ports of Roman Egypt. It was written by an anonymous sailor from Alexandria. It has also mentioned the items to be imported and exported from India.

## Maurya Empire

**1. The first Empire was established by which ruler in India?**

- (a) Chandragupta Maurya
- (b) Ashoka
- (c) Kanishka
- (d) Chandragupta-II Vikramaditya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**66<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020**

**Ans. (a)**

Chandragupta Maurya is considered one of the greatest emperors of India. He was the first emperor who brought together the small fragmented kingdoms of the country and combined them into a single large empire. He expanded his empire to the edge of what is now known as Iran. He was the one who first unified India politically.

**2. Chandragupta Maurya figures prominently in the book of –**

- (a) Bhasa
- (b) Sudraka
- (c) Vishakhadatta
- (d) Ashvaghosha

**46<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2004**

**Ans. (c)**

Mudrarakshasa authored by Vishakhadatta provides various information about the reign of Chandragupta Maurya. Dhundiraja had written a commentary on Mudrarakshasa. In this drama, Chandragupta is described as the son of Nandiraja. This book depicts Chandragupta as "Vrishal" and "Kulheen".

**3. Who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya?**

- (a) William Jones
- (b) V. Smith
- (c) R. K. Mukherjee
- (d) D. R. Bhandarkar

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (a)**

William Jones was the first scholar who recognized Sandrokottos as Chandra Gupta Maurya. Arian and Plutarch also described him as Androkottos.

**4. Kautilya's Arthashastra is a book on -**

- (a) Economic relations
- (b) Principles and practice of statecraft
- (c) Foreign policy
- (d) Wealth accumulation
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017**

**Ans. (e)**

Arthashastra by Kautilya is the treatise on polity during the Mauryan monarch/kingdom. The Saptang theory of the state was first introduced in it, which includes the seven elements of the states, these are – The King (Swami), Minister (Amatya), Territory (Janpada), Fort (Durg), Treasury (Kosa), Army (Danda) and Allies (Mitra). Arthashastra gives a detailed description of the then administration and agrarian system.

5. **Kautilya's Arthashastra deals with the aspects of –**

- (a) Economic life (b) Political policies  
(c) Religious life (d) Social life

45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

Arthashastra renders a wide range of information about Mauryan dynasty. This is the unique saga of political policies.

6. **Chandragupta's palace situated at Pataliputra is mainly made up of –**

- (a) Bricks (b) Stones  
(c) Woods (d) Clays

41<sup>st</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (c)

The archaeological remains of the Mauryan period have been discovered in Bulandibagh and Kumrahar near Patna (Ancient Pataliputra). It is known that the palace of Chandragupta Maurya was made of wood. The excavation was carried out by D.B. Spooner. The remains of the city wall from Bulandibagh and the remains of palace from Kumrahar have been found during the excavation.

7. **Who amongst the following Mauryan rulers did conquer the Deccan?**

- (a) Ashoka (b) Chandragupta  
(c) Bindusara (d) Kunala

46<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (b)

The founder of the Mauryan dynasty, Chandragupta Maurya conquered the Deccan plateau. Jain and Tamil sources inscriptions found at various sites of southern India proved that Chandragupta Maurya expanded his empire into Deccan trap. Inscriptions of Ashoka were also found in many sites in the southern part of India, but he conquered the Kalinga only. In this situation, Chandragupta should be given the credit for Deccan Victory as Victory of Bindusara is doubtful and history never remembered him as a victor.

8. **Which book describes Bindusara as an anointed Kshatriya?**

- (a) Arthashastra (b) Indica

- (c) Divyavadana (d) Rajatarangini  
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Auditor 2021

Ans. (c)

Buddhist account Divyavadana describes Bindusara, son of Chandragupta, as an anointed Kshatriya.

9. **The Inscription which proves Chandragupta's sway over western India is:**

- (a) Kalinga Rock Inscription  
(b) Girnar Rock Inscription of Ashoka  
(c) Junagarh Rock Inscription of Rudradaman  
(d) Sopara Rock Inscription of Ashoka

39<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The description of the construction of irrigation dam by Mauryan provincial governor "Pushyagupta" was found from the Junagarh rock inscription of Rudradaman which proves that this western part of India was once the part of Mauryan empire.

10. **Which one territory of the following was not a part of Ashoka's empire?**

- (a) Afghanistan (b) Bihar  
(c) Sri Lanka (d) Kalinga

42<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

Sri Lanka was not part of Ashoka's territory. The second inscription of Ashoka clarifies that Chola, Pandayas, Sattiyaputta, Keralaputta and Tamraparni (Sri Lanka) were not the part of Mauryan reign. That's why they were called as edge states.

11. **A Buddhist Council during the reign of Ashoka was held at –**

- (a) Magadha (b) Pataliputra  
(c) Samastipur (d) Rajgriha

45<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (b)

According to Sinhalese Folklore – "Dipavamsa" and "Mahavamsa", the Third Buddhist Council was held in "Pataliputra" during the reign of Ashoka.

12. **Language used in the inscriptions of Ashoka is:**

- (a) Sanskrit (b) Prakrit  
(c) Pali (d) Hindi

44<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Ashokan inscriptions describe the history of Ashoka properly. The inscription can be divided into three classes;

- (1) Rock inscription / petrography
- (2) Column inscription
- (3) Cave inscription.

Rock inscription is the group of 14 various inscriptions that found at eight different places –

Shahbazgarhi, Mansehra, Kalsi, Girnar, Dhauili, Jaugada, Yerraguddi and Sopara. Most of the inscription of Ashoka are written in Prakrit language and Brahmi script, only two inscriptions, Shahbazgarhi and Mansehra's are in Kharoshti script. One ruined inscription, written in Aramaic script, was found in Taxila. Shar-i-Kuna (Kandhar Inscription) is in the bilingual (Greek-Aramaic) script while one Aramaic script of Ashokan inscription was obtained from Laghman.

**13. Which one of the following scripts of ancient India was written from right to left?**

- (a) Brahmi
- (b) Sharada
- (c) Kharosthi
- (d) Nandanagari
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**65<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019**

**Ans. (c)**

The Kharosthi Script is an ancient script used by the ancient Gandhara culture of South Asia primarily in modern-day Afghanistan & Pakistan Kharoshti was A cursive script written from right to left.

**14. Who first deciphered the Brahmi script ?**

- (a) A. Cunningham
- (b) A.H. Dani
- (c) Buhler
- (d) James Prinsep

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (d)**

The Brahmi script was first deciphered through the letters inscribed on stone tablets. Sir James Prinsep was the first philologist who accomplished the task of deciphering the script of Ashokan inscription. So, option (d) is the correct answer.

**15. The name by which Ashoka is referred to his inscriptions is :**

- (a) Chakravarti
- (b) Dharmadeva
- (c) Dharmakirti
- (d) Priyadarshi
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**65<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019**

**Ans. (d)**

The name by which Ashoka is referred in his inscription is "Priyadarshi", "Devanampiya Piyadasi" which means "Beloved of the Gods". He has also been stated as "Ashok Vardhan" in Puranas.

**16. The only pillar on which Ashoka declares himself as the emperor of Magadha –**

- (a) Minor pillar of Maski
- (b) Rummindei pillar
- (c) Queen pillar
- (d) Bhabru pillar

**39<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994**

**Ans. (d)**

Bhabru's (Bairat) inscription proves Ashoka as Buddhist. In the same inscription, he referred to himself as 'Piyadasi Raja' Magadha, i.e. the king of Magadha.

**17. The central point in Ashoka's Dhamma is -**

- (a) Loyalty to the king
- (b) Peace and non-violence
- (c) Respect to elders
- (d) Religious toleration
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017**

**Ans. (e)**

Ashoka's Dhamma was primarily based on policy of peace, non-violence & religious toleration. In his 12<sup>th</sup> rock edict, religious longanimity and growth of the essence of all communities are mentioned. Hence as per the options, (e) is correct.

**18. In which inscription, Kalinga victory is mentioned?**

- (a) Maski Inscription
- (b) Rudradaman Inscription
- (c) Junagarh Inscription
- (d) Hathigumpha Inscription
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**66<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. Re-Exam (Pre) 2020**

**Ans. (e)**

Kalinga Victory is mentioned in Ashoka's Rock Edict Number 13. Hence, option (e) is the correct answer.

**19. Megasthenes was the ambassador of -**

- (a) Seleucus
- (b) Alexander
- (c) Darius
- (d) the Greeks
- (e) None of the above/ More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C (Pre.) 2017**

**Ans. (a)**

Megasthenes was a Greek historian who came to India in the Fourth Century B.C. as a representative of Seleucus Nicator.

**20. In how many categories did Megasthenes divide the Indian Society?**

- (a) Four
- (b) Five
- (c) Six
- (d) Seven

**46<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003**

**Ans. (d)**

Megasthenes divided Mauryan society into seven categories in his book 'Indica', which are as follows :

(1) Philosophers (2) Farmers (3) Herdsmen (4) Artisans (5) Military (Soldier) (6) Overseers or Spies (7) Councillors and Assessors. Megasthenes does not mention slavery in India. According to him, no one could marry outside his caste, and no one could take to occupation from the one fixed for his caste according to the Varnasystem.

**21. The division of Mauryan society into seven classes is particularly mentioned in:**

- (a) Kautilya's Arthashastra
- (b) Ashokan edicts
- (c) The Puranas
- (d) The Indica of Megasthenes
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**63<sup>rd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2017**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of the above question.

**22. The description of the administration of Pataliputra is available in?**

- (a) Divyanadan
- (b) Arthashastra
- (c) Indica
- (d) Ashoka's inscriptions

**46<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2003**

**Ans. (c)**

The description of the administration of Pataliputra is found in Megasthenes' 'Indica'. Megasthenes mentioned six committees of five members each to look after the administration of Pataliputra. He referred to the town officials as 'Astynomi.'

**23. What is the name of Megasthenes' book?**

- (a) Economics
- (b) Rig Veda
- (c) Purana
- (d) Indica

**47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005**

**Ans. (d)**

See the explanation of the above question.

**24. Who was the author of 'Indica'?**

- (a) Vishnugupta
- (b) Megasthenes
- (c) Deimachus
- (d) Pliny

**56<sup>th</sup> to 59<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015**

**Ans. (b)**

See the explanation of the above question.

**25. The most famous centre of learning during Mauryan period was:**

- (a) Vaishali
- (b) Nalanda

(c) Taxila

(d) Ujjain

**47<sup>th</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005**

**Ans. (c)**

At present, Vaishali is a district of Bihar. It was related to both Buddhism and Jainism in ancient times. It was established in 6<sup>th</sup> century B.C. before the birth of Gautam Buddha (563 B.C.). Mahavira Swami was born in Kundapur near Vaishali. **Nalanda** – Nalanda was an important centre of Buddhist education. Firstly, Buddha temples were established here in the Gupta period.

**Taxila** – Taxila was a major centre of learning for Hindus and Buddhists who came here from all over the world to get education. It was situated few miles west of present Islamabad. It was most famous during the Mauryan period. Ujjain was the conventional capital of Chandragupta II (Vikramaditya).

**26. The last Mauryan emperor was:**

- (a) Jaloka
- (b) Avanti Verma
- (c) Nandi Vardhana
- (d) Brihadratha

**48<sup>th</sup> to 52<sup>nd</sup> B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008**

**Ans. (d)**

The last Mauryan emperor was Brihadratha. Brihadratha was assassinated by his commander/lieutenant Pushyamitra Shunga in 184 B.C. Pushyamitra Shunga established a new dynasty which is known as Shunga Dynasty.

**27. The decline of the Mauryan Empire was largely due to the economic consequences of Ashoka's policy. Who believed in this fact?**

- (a) Romila Thapar
- (b) D. N. Jha
- (c) V. A. Smith
- (d) H. C. Raychaudhuri
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

**B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022**

**Ans. (a)**

Renowned historian Romila Thapas believes that it was the economic consequences of Ashoka's policies that led to the decline of the Mauryan Empire.

**28. Pradyota was the king of–**

- (a) Kasi
- (b) Koshala
- (c) Magadha
- (d) Avanti
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

**B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018**

**Ans. (d)**

Pradyota was the ruler of the ancient Mahajanapada Avanti. Avanti is located in the present-day Madhya Pradesh State. Pradyota was contemporary to Gautama Buddha and Bimbisara.